Year 1 Admission Assessment

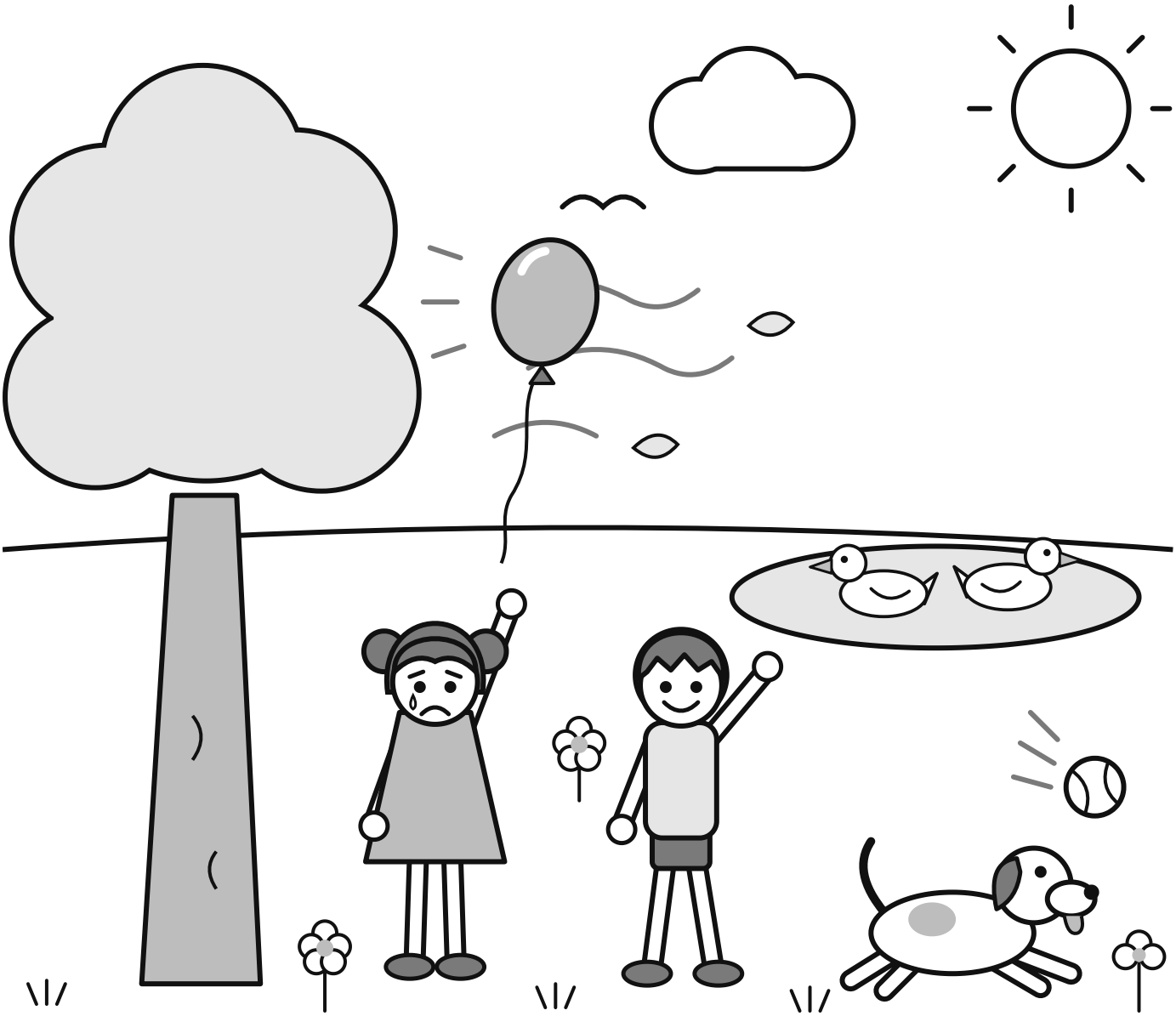
Version 3.1, October 2026

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Date	

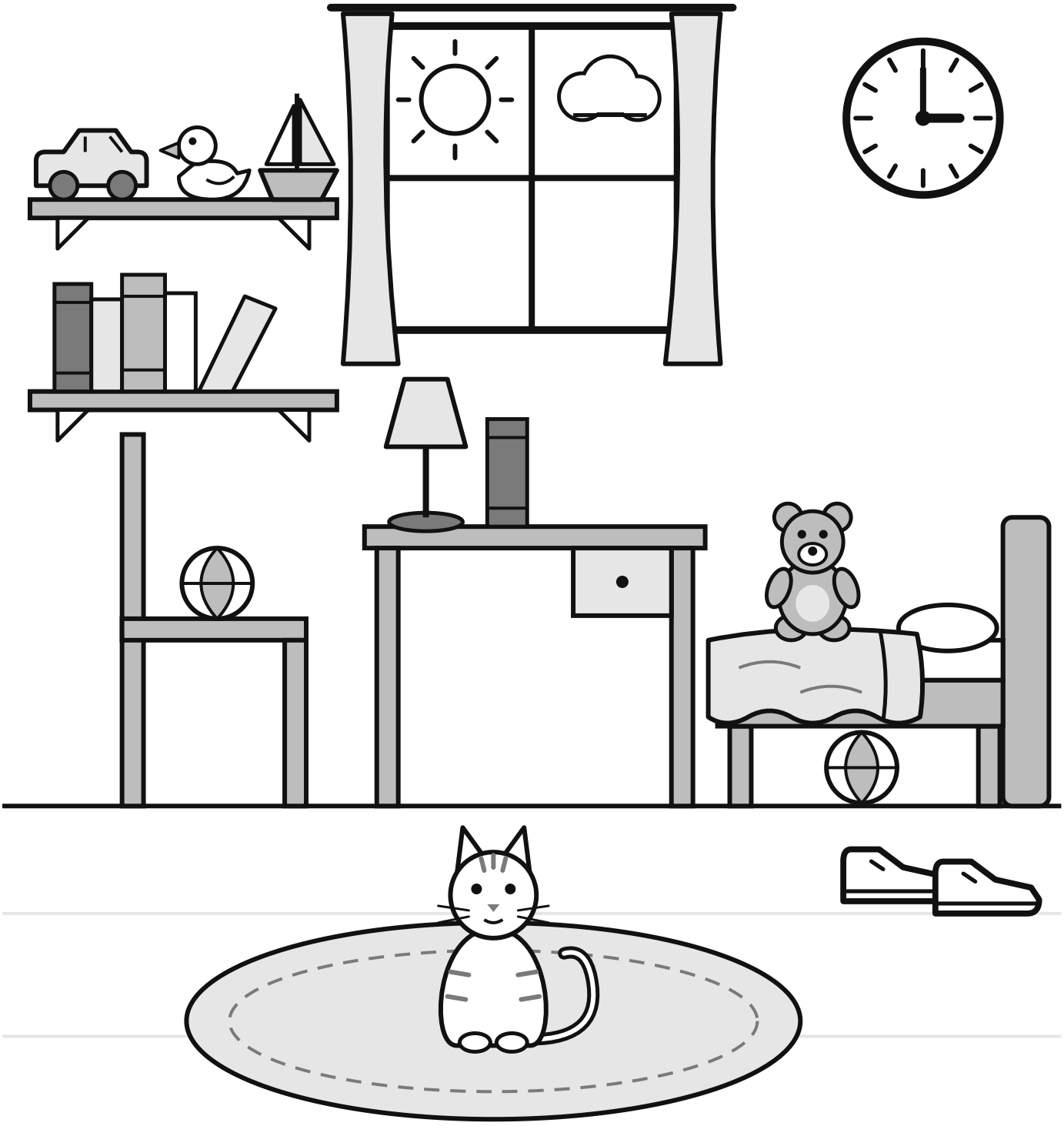


Hello!

Talk



Listen



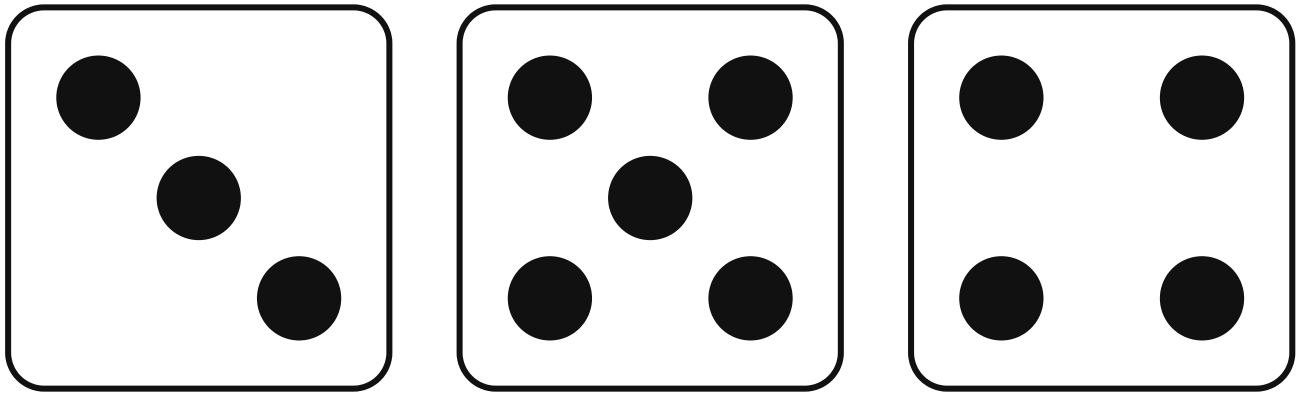
Maths

Section A: Number problems

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2 / 1



3 / 1

6	15	9
20	13	12

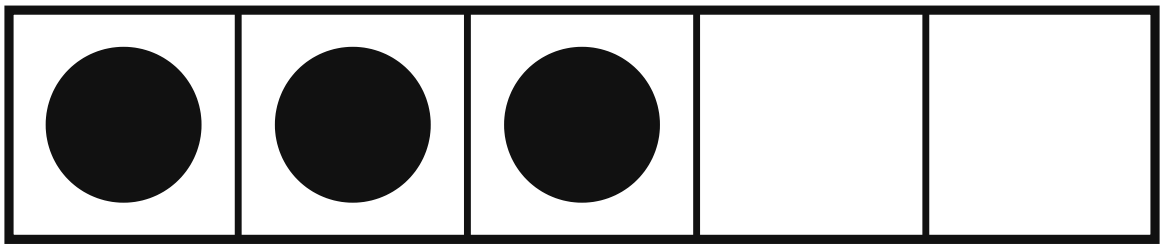
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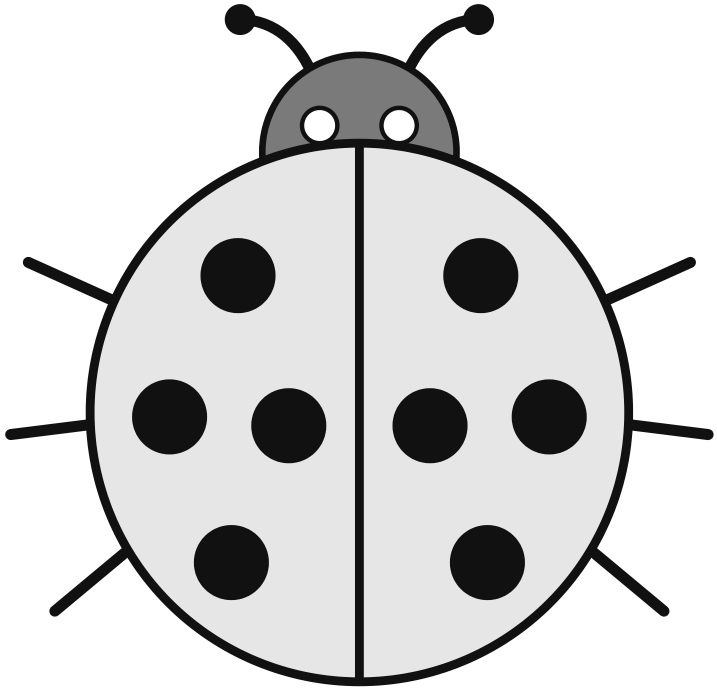
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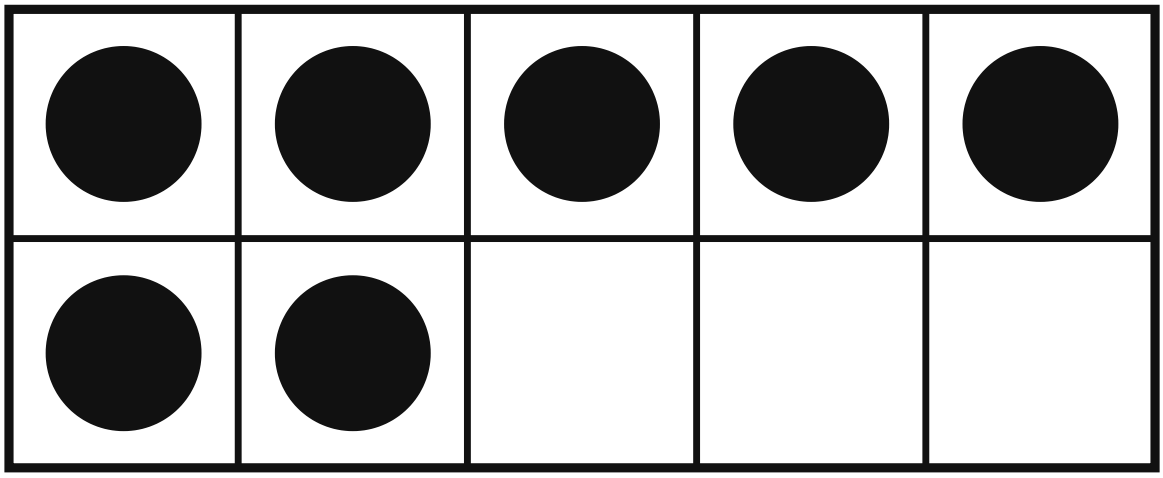
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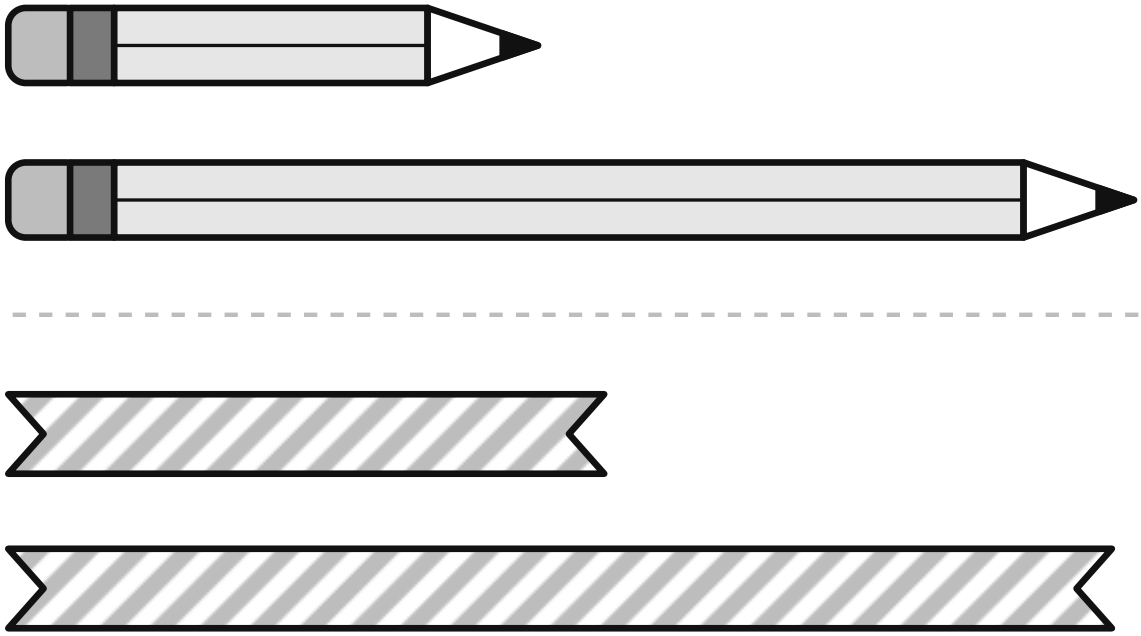


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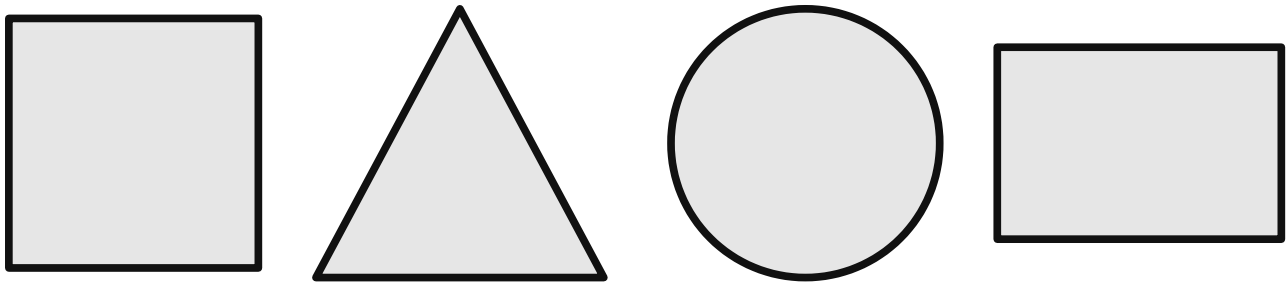


Section B: Word problems and pictures

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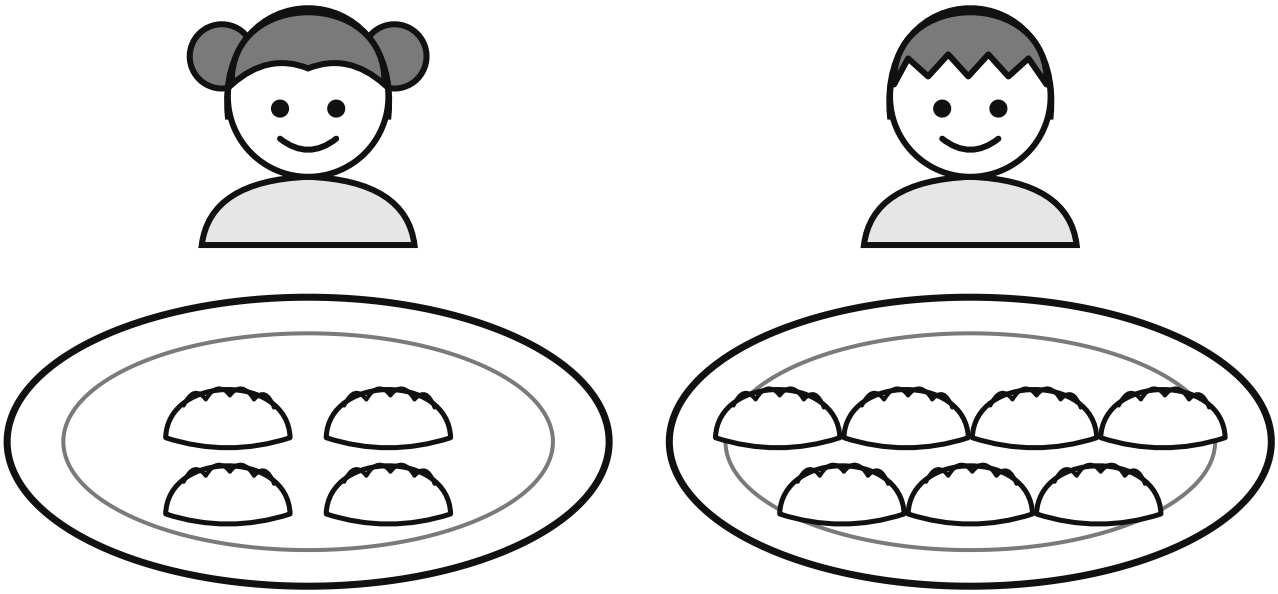


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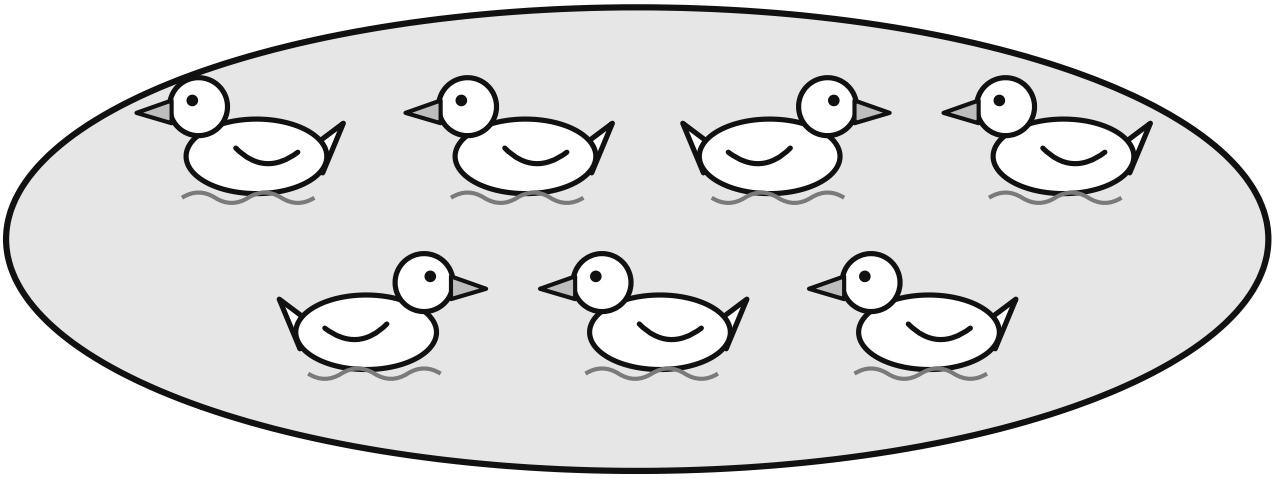
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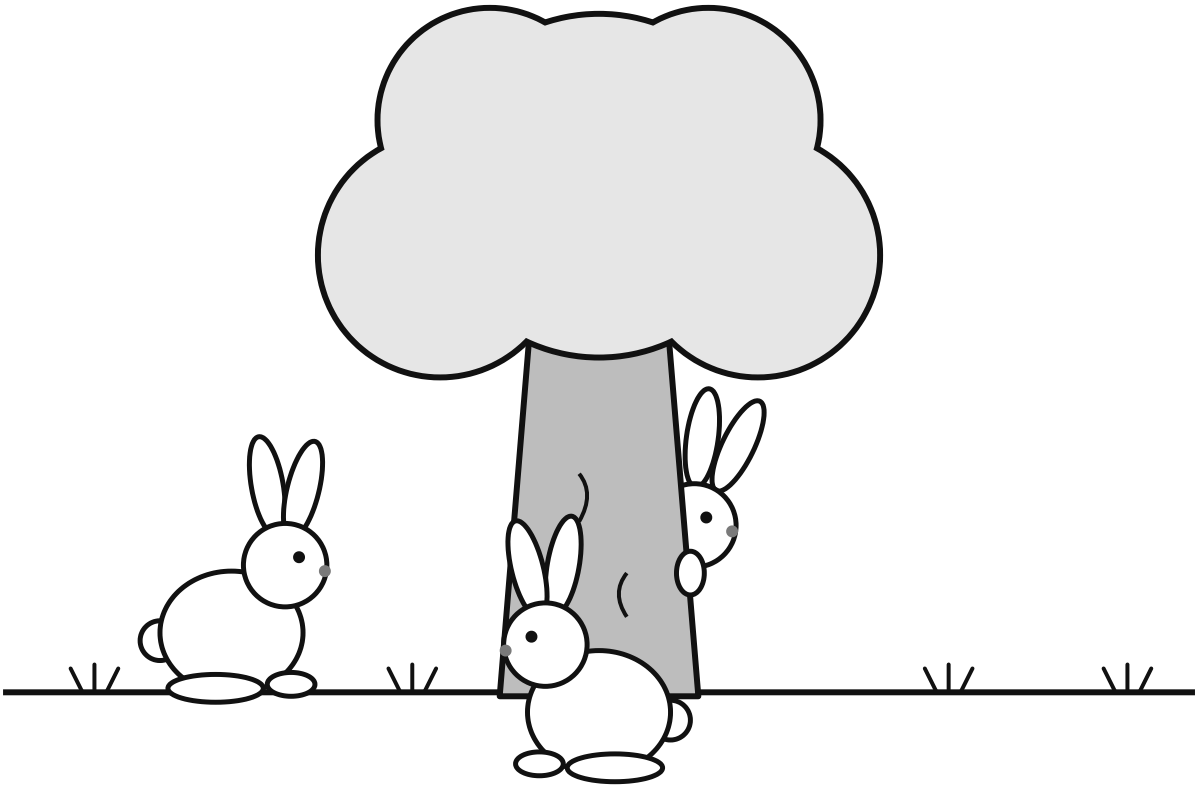
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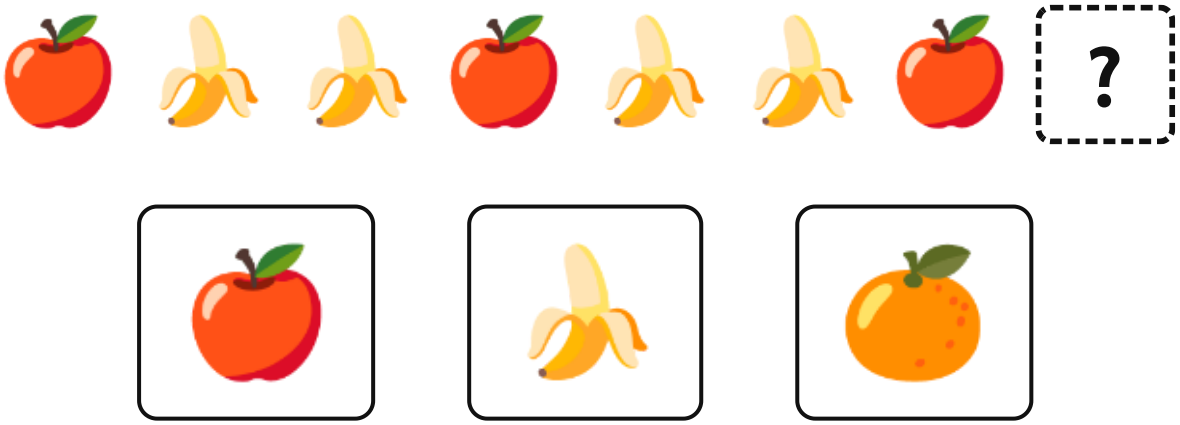
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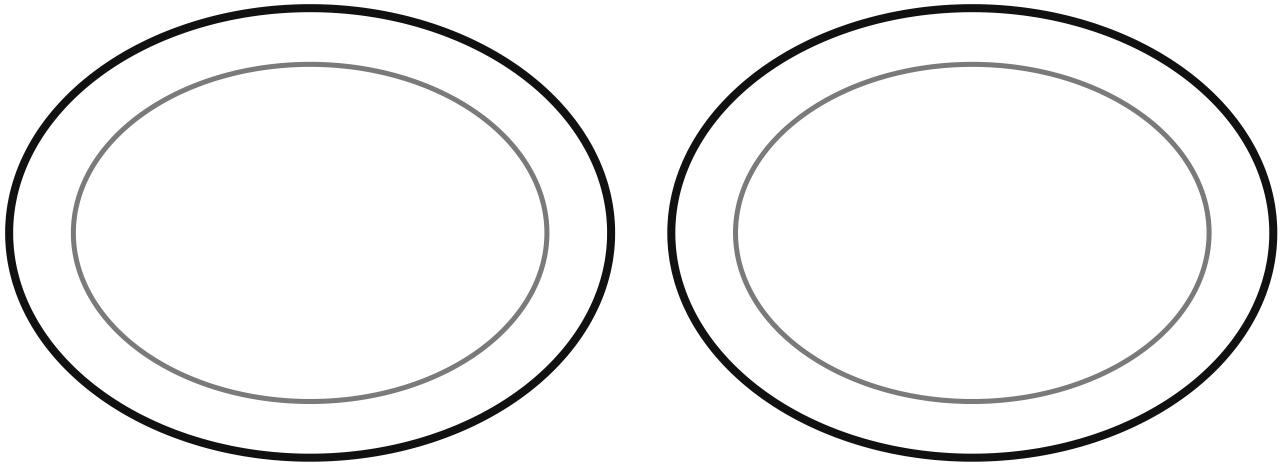


14

/ 1



15 / 1



Write

Name _____

Words

1 _____

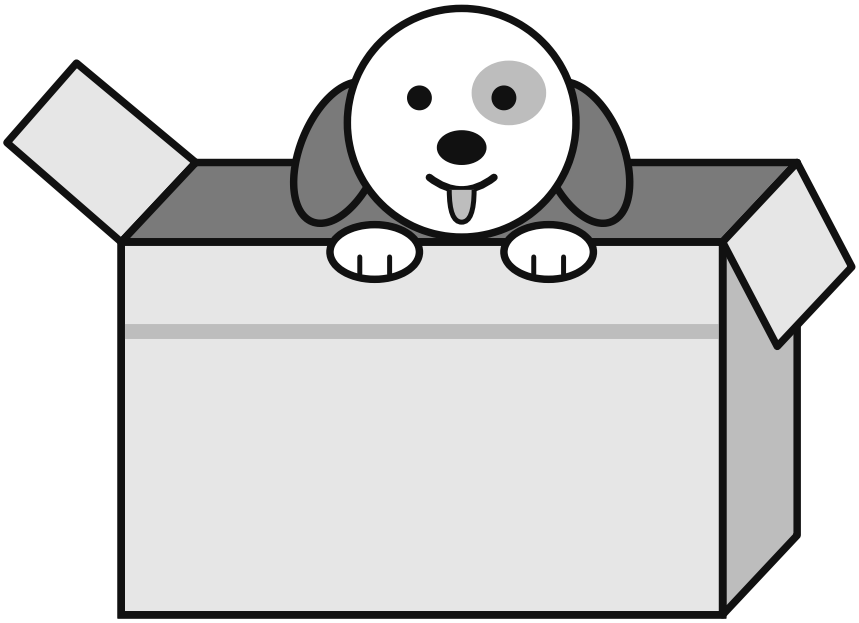
2 _____

3 _____

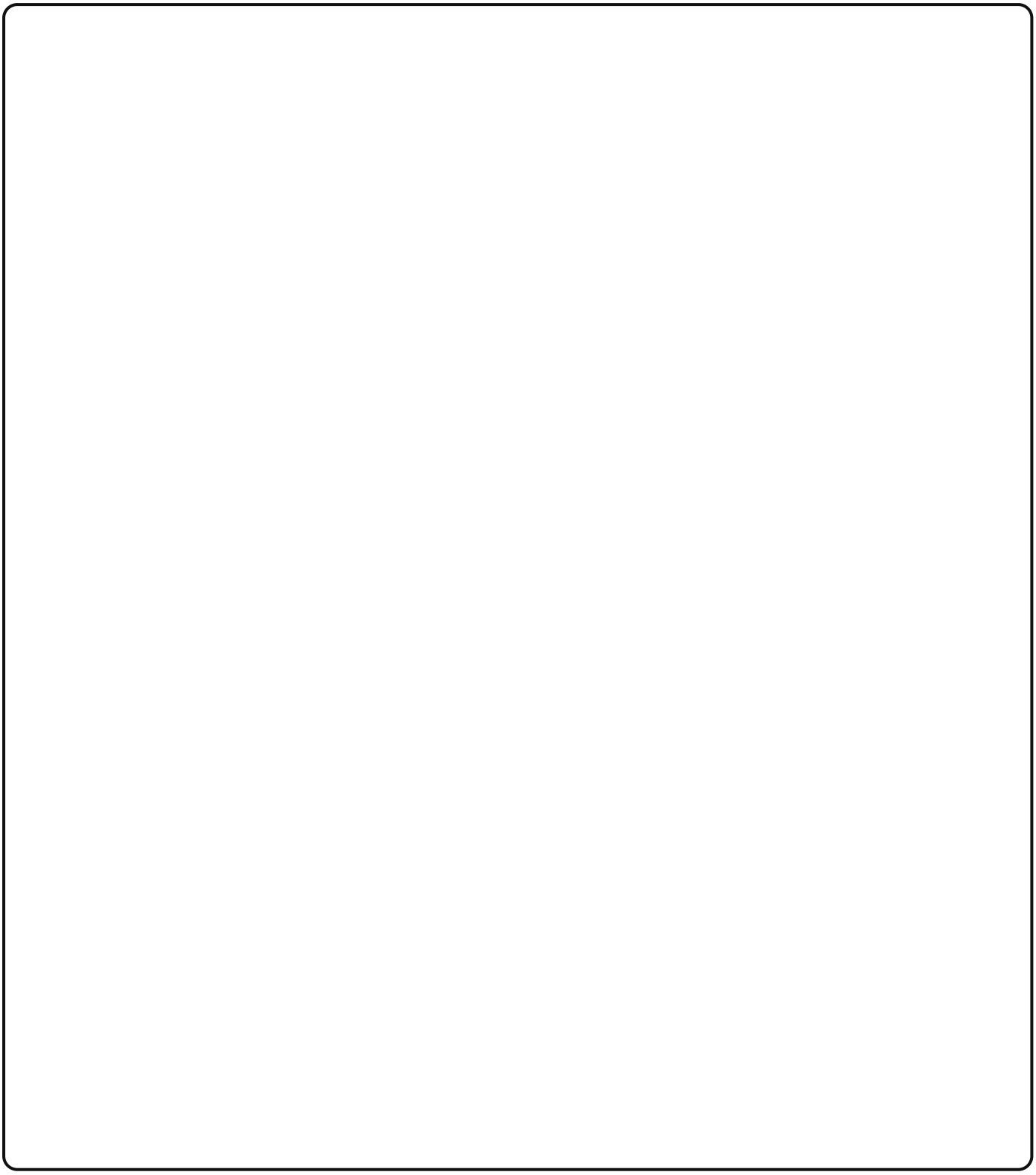
4 _____

5 _____

Write



Draw



Year 1 Admission Assessment v3.1: Assessor booklet

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y01/Y01_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

For a child joining **Year 1** (about 5 years old). Most have finished the middle year of a Chinese kindergarten (中班); some come from bilingual kindergartens. The visit takes **about 45 minutes, 1:1**, and should feel like play. **Print one copy of this booklet per child**: you write the listening score, notes and the score summary in it. The child uses the Year 1 student booklet; you write the maths marks in the mark boxes on the child's pages.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Student booklet	This booklet
1	Welcome	1	Assessor		page 1 (you write the child's name)	Section 2
2	Speaking: picture talk	4	Assessor		page 2	3.1
3	Listening: follow instructions	4	Assessor	crayons: red, blue, yellow, green	page 3	3.2
4	Reading: Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen	12	Assessor	shared cards and records, levelled books, plain card	(separate cards)	3.3
5	Movement break	2	Assessor	water		Section 2
6	Maths	12	Assessor	20 counters	pages 4 to 11	Section 4
7	Writing	5	Assessor	pencil	pages 12 and 13	3.4
8	Play-based interview and goodbye	6	Interviewer (often the assessor)	crayons, interview record	page 14	Section 5
	Total	**about 45** (43 minutes of tasks, plus the welcome and break)				

The order follows the blueprint for Years 1 to 3. This booklet puts all the English tasks together in Section 3, so **writing (3.4) comes after maths on the day**.

What to print

For each child	For the room (reuse; laminate the cards)
Year 1 student booklet: A4, single-sided, in colour if possible (the pictures also work in greyscale)	Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards.md`)
This assessor booklet	Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card.md`)
Early Reading Screen record (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record.md`)	Levelled reading books (`01_Reading_Books_and_Materials`)
Sentence reading record (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`)	20 counters, all the same colour and size (about 2 cm across), in a small pot
Interview record (`forms/Interview_Record_Y1_Y2.md`)	4 crayons (red, blue, yellow, green), 2 pencils, a rubber
Candidate Summary and Decision (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision.md`), completed after the visit	A plain card about A5 size (to cover pictures and sentences), a watch or timer

2. Before you start

The room. Use a low table. Sit beside the child at a corner of the table, not opposite. Keep the counters and crayons out of sight until each task needs them. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door: keep the door open or have a second adult in the room. Show the child where the parent will wait. If the child will not separate, the parent may sit quietly at the back without helping; note it.

Welcome (1 minute). Say:

> "Hello! My name is ___. What's your name?" (wait) "Hello, ___. How old are you?" (wait) "Today we are going to look at some pictures, play some games, count and draw. Some things are easy and some things are tricky. That's OK. Just try your best."

Write the child's name on the cover of the student booklet yourself (the child writes their name later, in the writing task). Note how the child first responds (English, Chinese, gesture, silence): it is early evidence for speaking and listening.

Access rules for Year 1

	English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading, writing	Maths
What you may say	Only the words in the script. Do not explain words, translate, point or show what to do. You may repeat an instruction once if the child asks or clearly did not hear: write **R**.	Any question, in English, as often as needed. You may point to the picture and show with counters.
Chinese	Not used by you.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after you have read it aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Mark the item **L**. The mark still counts.
Answers	English words, pointing and doing count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	Pointing, fingers, counters and number words in English all count. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the child or parent tells you the child has not met an idea, mark **NT**. It scores 0; list it in the summary. Five year olds rarely say this themselves, so otherwise score 0 and write a note.

Codes in this booklet: **R** instruction repeated once; **L** language support in maths; **NT** not yet taught. Extra time, a reader or extra breaks for a known need are allowed: record them in the score summary.

Keeping the child at ease

- Praise effort, never correctness: "You are working hard!", "Thank you!", "Good listening!" Use the same warm tone after right and wrong answers. Never say "No" or "Wrong", and do not correct.
- A silent child is common: many young children new to English go through a silent period. Smile, wait, move on. Pointing tasks still work. Never pressure the child.
- If the child is tired, take a short extra break. If the child becomes upset, stop, comfort them and let them go to the parent. Try again later if they recover; otherwise end the visit and record what was done.

Stopping rules

Task	Stop when
Picture talk	the child has not answered three prompts in a row. Finish with an easy "What's this?" so the child ends with success.
Listening	three items in a row score 0. Score the rest 0.
Reading screens	as each shared record says.
Maths	three items in a row score 0 in Section A: go on to Section B, which starts easy again. Three in a row score 0 in Section B: stop.
Writing	the child says they cannot do more after one encouragement ("Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear.").

Movement break (about 2 minutes, after reading). Say: "Let's have a break! Stand up. Stretch up high. Touch your toes. Jump three times. Now sit down." Do the actions with the child. It is not scored. Offer water and the toilet.

3. English

3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, student booklet page 2)

The picture shows a windy day in a park: the wind is blowing a girl's balloon away and she is sad because she cannot reach the string; a boy has thrown a ball and a dog is running after it; two ducks swim on a pond; the sun is out and leaves blow in the wind.

How. Open the booklet at page 2. Give the prompts in order. Wait about 5 seconds after each one; if there is no answer, go on to the next prompt. You may repeat a prompt once. Do not name things for the child or finish their sentences. Write down what the child says, as close to their words as you can ("dog run", "she sad balloon fly").

Step	Say	Listen for	What the child said
1 Open	"Look at this picture. What can you see?"	Any naming: tree, balloon, girl, boy, dog, ball, duck, pond, sun, cloud, bird, flower	
2 Naming	Point to each and ask "What's this?": the dog, the ball, the balloon, a duck	dog, ball, balloon, duck. Named in English: ___ / 4	
3 Action	Point to the dog. "What is the dog doing?"	running, chasing the ball, playing	
4 Action	Point to the boy. "What is the boy doing?"	throwing the ball, playing with the dog	
5 Feeling	Point to the girl. "How does she feel?"	sad, unhappy, crying, upset, cross	
6 Explaining	"Why?"	her balloon is flying away; the wind blew it; she can't reach the string	
7 Telling	"Tell me what is happening in the picture."	joined ideas: "The girl's balloon is flying away and the dog is running after the ball."	
8 Predicting	"What do you think will happen next?"	the balloon will fly up to the clouds or get caught in the tree; the boy will try to catch it; her mum will buy a new one; the dog will catch the ball	
9 Personal	"Do you like the park? What do you do at the park?"	talks about their own life	

Speaking band at age 5 (examples from this picture)

Band	What it sounds like at age 5	Example
A New to English	Silent, nods or points; perhaps one or two English words; may speak in Chinese	points to the dog; "狗"; "dog"
B Early acquisition	Names several things in English; single words and two-word phrases; little description	"dog", "ball", "a duck", "balloon fly"
C Developing competence	Short sentences with a verb, often with errors; can say what someone is doing	"The dog is run." "She sad." "Boy throw the ball."
D Competent	Connected sentences; explains with "because"; tells the picture as a little story; errors do not get in the way	"She is sad because her balloon fly away." "Maybe the boy help her."
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking 5 year old does: full sentences, words such as blowing, chasing, windy, reach, and ideas of their own	"The wind blew her balloon away and she can't reach the string. I think it will go up to the clouds, and her mummy will buy her a new one."

Speaking band from the picture talk: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**. The final speaking band is the best fit of the picture talk and the interview (Section 5).

What to look for

- A strong response needs few prompts, joins ideas (and, because, then) and predicts ("maybe", "I think"). A weak one needs every prompt and gives one word or repeats your question.
- Do not count against the child: missing -s, -ed, "a" and "the"; "he" and "she" mixed up; accent features (l and r, light final consonants). These are normal for learners.
- A child who names little in English but, as the parent describes, talks well in Chinese has an English barrier only. A child who says very little in either language may need a speech and language check: see the interview record.

3.2 Listening: follow instructions (4 minutes, page 3)

Set up. Open the booklet at page 3 (the bedroom). Put the four crayons on the table: red, blue, yellow and green. Do not name the colours.

Say: "Let's play a listening game. Look at this picture. Listen carefully and do what I say. Ready?" Practice, not scored: "Put your finger on the picture." (Smile.) "Good!"

Rules

- Say each instruction **once**, at a natural, steady pace. Look at the child, not at the picture: children follow your eyes. Do not point, nod or gesture.
- If the child asks, or clearly did not hear, you may say it once more: tick **R**. A correct response after one repeat still scores.
- For colouring, a small mark of the right colour on the right thing is enough. Say "Just a little bit of colour is fine" if the child starts colouring carefully.
- **Score 1** only when every part is right, and in the right order where the instruction says "then" or "before". Otherwise 0. No half marks.
- Stop after three 0s in a row.

No.	Say	Type	Correct response	R	Mark
1	"Point to the cat."	one step	the cat on the rug		
2	"Point to the window."	one step	anywhere inside the window frame (the sun or cloud seen through it is fine)		
3	"Point to the ball under the bed."	position: under	the ball under the bed, not the ball on the chair		
4	"Point to the book next to the lamp."	position: next to	the book standing on the desk beside the lamp, not the books on the shelf		
5	"Point to the toy between the car and the boat."	position: between	the toy duck on the top shelf		
6	"Point to the teddy, then point to the shoes."	two steps	the teddy on the bed, then the shoes on the floor, in that order		
7	"Colour the lamp yellow and colour the boat blue."	two steps	yellow on the lamp and blue on the boat (either order)		
8	"Draw a circle round the clock, then colour the ball on the chair red."	two steps	a circle round the clock, then red on the ball on the chair (not the ball under the bed)		
9	"Before you colour the car green, point to the bed."	sequence: before	points to the bed **first**, then colours the car green		
10	"If there is a moon in the window, colour it yellow. If there is a sun in the window, draw a circle round it."	condition: if	draws a circle round the sun in the window and does not colour it (there is no moon)		
	Total				**/ 10**

Band guide (Year 1)

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8 to 10
Listening band	A	B	C	D	E

What to look for

- Items 1 and 2 need everyday nouns; 3 to 5 need the position words under, next to and between; 6 to 8 need the child to hold a longer piece of English in mind; 9 and 10 need grammar ("before", "if").
- Right object, wrong colour: score 0, but note it. Colour words may be the only gap.

- A child who does only the first part of every two-step item is probably holding too much new English at once, not showing a memory difficulty. A child who answers quickly and correctly but watches your face closely may be using your eyes as clues: keep looking at the child.

3.3 Reading: Early Reading Screen and Graded Sentence Reading Screen (12 minutes)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards.md` and `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record.md`) starting at the letter sounds (Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right) and then the Section 1 words (Year 1 start point in the guide, Section 2); and the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card.md` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`) starting at Level 1.

The full scripts and rules for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide.md`. Follow the scripts, scoring and stopping rules in each shared record; this booklet has no reading tasks of its own. All answers are in English, including the answers to the questions about what the child has just read. Many children starting Year 1 read very little English, and many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points on the sentence screen at this age, so stop kindly and praise the child's effort. Copy the results into the score summary (Section 6). Then take the movement break.

3.4 Writing (5 minutes, pages 12 and 13; given after maths)

Give the child a pencil. Do not spell any word, sound out, or write for the child.

Part 1: name (page 12). Point to the line next to "Name". Say: "Can you write your name here?" Note which script the child uses (English letters, pinyin or Chinese characters).

Part 2: five words (page 12). Say: "Now I will say some words. Write each word here. Listen to the sounds in the word. Have a go. It is fine if it is not right." For each word, point to the number, then say the word, the sentence and the word again, clearly and at a normal pace (do not stretch the sounds). Allow about 30 seconds; if nothing is written, say "That's fine. Next one."

No.	Say	Word	Spelling pattern
1	"sun. The sun is hot. sun."	sun	CVC
2	"fan. The fan goes round and round. fan."	fan	CVC
3	"pen. I can write with a pen. pen."	pen	CVC
4	"ship. The ship is on the sea. ship."	ship	digraph sh
5	"chop. Mum can chop the carrots. chop."	chop	digraph ch

None of the five words is on the reading cards, so the child has not just seen them written.

Part 3: a sentence about a picture (page 13). Point to the picture (a puppy in a box). Say: "Look at the picture. What can you see?" Let the child say it, and do not correct or improve their words. Then say: "Can you write about it? Write it here." If the child says they can't: "Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear." If the child writes one word, say once: "Can you write some more?" When they finish, say "Can you read it to me?" and write down what they say: it helps you read their spelling.

Writing checklist

Area	Tick what you see	Notes
Name	☐ recognisable ☐ capital first, then lower case ☐ English letters ☐ pinyin ☐ Chinese characters	
Handwriting	☐ holds the pencil with control ☐ most letters correctly formed ☐ letters sit on the line	
Sentence	☐ about the picture ☐ left to right ☐ spaces between words ☐ capital letter ☐ full stop ☐ can read it back	

Word	What the child wrote	Correct	All sounds shown ("fen", "shep", "chup")	Some sounds ("sp", "c")	Nothing
sun		☐	☐	☐	☐
fan		☐	☐	☐	☐
pen		☐	☐	☐	☐
ship		☐	☐	☐	☐
chop		☐	☐	☐	☐

Four criteria. Score each 0 to 4 (1 and 3 lie between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4	Score
Content and organisation	Nothing written, or marks not linked to the picture	One or two words or a phrase about the picture ("dog box")	A complete idea about the picture, perhaps with a second idea ("The dog is in the box. He is happy.")	/ 4
Vocabulary	No English words	Simple nouns (dog, box)	Words chosen for meaning: puppy, sitting, happy, big, peeping	/ 4
Grammar and sentences	No phrase or sentence	A phrase, or a sentence with words missing ("dog in box")	A simple sentence with a verb ("The dog is in the box."); may join two ideas with "and"	/ 4
Spelling and punctuation (the five words and the sentence)	Random letters, or letters not linked to sounds	Most dictated words show some sounds, usually the first and last ("sn", "fn"); one or two words correct	All or nearly all dictated words correct or with all sounds shown, including sh and ch; a capital letter or a full stop in the sentence	/ 4
			Total	**/ 16**

Writing band (best fit with the descriptors; the totals are only a guide)

Band	Writing at age 5	Typical total
A	Makes marks, copies, or writes their name only; may write in Chinese; dictated words not attempted or random letters	0 to 3
B	Some letters match sounds (often first sounds); one or two dictated words with most sounds; a word or label for the picture	4 to 7
C	Most dictated words show most sounds and some are correct; a phrase or short sentence that can be read with help	8 to 10
D	Most dictated words correct; a simple sentence that another adult can read, with spaces between words	11 to 13
E	Comparable to a fluent English-speaking 5 year old (below)	14 to 16

What band E looks like at age 5. The child writes their name correctly (capital letter, then lower case), writes all five words correctly or with one small slip ("chopp"), and writes one or two simple sentences about the picture that another adult can read, with spaces between the words and usually a capital letter and a full stop. Most letters are correctly formed. This matches the end-of-Reception expectation (the Early Learning Goal for writing) for a fluent English speaker.

Spelling from children who speak Chinese

- Pinyin letter values often appear: "x" for sh ("xip" for ship), "q" or "c" for ch ("qop" for chop). Count these as "all sounds shown" and copy them into the notes: the child hears every sound but needs the English letters taught.
- Vowel swaps (e and a: "pan" for pen; u and a: "san" for sun) and missing final sounds ("pe", "cho") are features of a learner's English.
- Many Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach formal writing, pinyin or characters before primary school, so letter writing **may not have been taught**. A blank page is not, on its own, a sign of a learning difficulty.

What to look for

- Strong: hears every sound in the CVC words, uses sh and ch, writes a sentence without help.
- English barrier: forms letters well and spells by sound, but writes the sentence in Chinese or pinyin. The child knows how to write, but not yet what to write in English.
- Note pencil grip and letter formation separately: fine motor control is not English.

4. Maths (12 minutes, student booklet pages 4 to 11)

Content: the end of Reception (Early Years goals). **Section A: Number problems** (items 1 to 8, 8 marks). **Section B: Word problems and pictures** (items 9 to 15, 7 marks, with 3 word problems: 11, 12 and 15). Total 15 marks.

How

- Put the pot of 20 counters on the table. Say: "Now let's play some number games. You can use these counters to help you."
- Read each question as written. Then you may repeat it in English as often as needed, point to the picture and show with counters. A Chinese-speaking colleague may say it once in Chinese (mark **L**).
- The child answers by pointing, saying, showing fingers or moving counters. Number words must be in English; a child who cannot yet say the number may show it with fingers or counters, or point to it.
- Write 1 or 0 in the mark box on the child's page as you go, and NT or L beside the box. Do not say whether an answer is right.
- Stop as in Section 2: three 0s in a row in Section A, go to Section B; three in a row in Section B, stop.

Section A: Number problems

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
1	Point to the fish. "How many fish? Count them."	**7** (said in English, or shown with fingers or counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Watch: touches each fish once; says the last number as the answer.
2	Before you say anything, cover all three dot cards with the plain card. "I will show you some dots very quickly. Tell me how many. Don't count, just look." Slide the card to show only the first dot card for about 2 seconds, then cover it again. Do the same with the second and then the third (cover the cards you are not showing with the card or your hand).	**3, 5, 4**. 1 mark for all three.	Two seconds is too short to count one by one, so quick correct answers show the child sees the amount.
3	Point to the number cards. "Point to 9." "Point to 15." Point to 12: "What number is this?" Point to 20: "What number is this?"	**9, 15**, "twelve", "twenty". 1 mark for all four. 十二 and 二十 count (L).	Common slips: 6 for 9, 13 for 15, "twenty" for 12. Note them.
4	Point to the stars. "How many stars? You can put a counter on each star."	**16** (said in English, or shown with counters). A number said in Chinese scores 0.	Counting past 10 accurately; watch for missed or double-counted stars.

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
5	Point to the 8 dots. "Here are 8 dots." Point to the dashed circle. "One more dot comes here. How many dots now?" You may put a counter in the circle.	**9**. Counting all from 1 or knowing straight away both score; note which.	"9!" straight away shows stronger number sense than counting from 1.
6	Point to the five frame. "This box has space for 5 dots. Here are 3 dots. How many more dots make 5?"	**2**. Pointing to the 2 empty squares and saying 2, or putting 2 counters in, scores.	Five frames may not have been taught.
7	Point to the ladybird. "This ladybird has 4 spots on this side (point) and 4 spots on this side (point). Double 4. How many spots altogether?"	**8**. Counting all scores.	The words "double" and "altogether" may not have been taught; the picture carries the meaning.
8	Point to the ten frame. "This box has space for 10 dots. Here are 7 dots. How many more dots make 10?"	**3**. Counters in the empty squares and counting score.	Number bonds to 10 may not have been taught.
		Section A total	**/ 8**

Section B: Word problems and pictures (WP = word problem)

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
9	Point to the pencils. "Point to the longer pencil." Point to the ribbons. "Point to the shorter ribbon."	The **bottom pencil**, then the **top ribbon**. 1 mark for both.	The longer pencil and the shorter ribbon are in different rows, so a child who always points to the same row will not score by chance.
10	"Point to the circle." "Point to the triangle." Point to the square: "What is this shape called?"	**circle, triangle**, "square". 1 mark for all three. 正方形 counts (L).	"Rectangle" for the square scores 0; note it.
11 WP	Point to the girl: "This is Mei." Point to the boy: "This is Jun." "Mei has 4 dumplings. Jun has 7 dumplings. Who has more dumplings?" (wait) "Who has fewer dumplings?"	**Jun**, then **Mei** (pointing to the child or the plate is fine). 1 mark for both.	If the child does not respond to "fewer", you may also ask "Who has less?"; note it.
12 WP	Point to the pond. "There are 7 ducks on the pond. 1 duck swims away. How many ducks are on the pond now?" The child may cover a duck with a finger or a counter.	**6**.	One less, in a story.
13	Point to the tree. "Point to the rabbit behind the tree." (wait) "Point to the rabbit in front of the tree."	**Behind**: the rabbit peeping out from behind the trunk (only its head, ears and a paw show). **In front**: the rabbit sitting against the bottom of the trunk. 1 mark for both.	The rabbit on the left is next to the tree: it is the other choice. Position words are taught in Chinese (前面, 后面, 旁边), so the English may be the only gap.
14	Run your finger along the row without naming the fruit. "Look at this pattern." Point to the question mark. "What comes next?" Point to the three pictures below: "This, this or this?"	**banana** (pointing to it, or saying "banana" or 香蕉, L).	Do not say the fruit names aloud: the sound of the pattern gives the answer away.
15 WP	Put 8 counters by the plates. "These are 8 biscuits. Mum puts them on 2 plates. Each plate has the same. How many biscuits are on each plate?"	**4**, with 4 counters on each plate. If the child shares correctly but does not say a number, ask "How many on this plate?" and accept the answer.	Watch the method: dealing one at a time, or guessing and fixing.

No.	Say and do	Answer, and what else is acceptable	Notes
		Section B total (of which word problems 11, 12, 15: **/ 3**)	**/ 7**
		Maths total	**/ 15**

Band guide (provisional; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates)

Total	0 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 12	13 to 15
Band	1 Well below expected	2 Working towards	3 Expected	4 Greater depth

Number problems and word problems. Items 11, 12 and 15 use the same number ideas as Section A, but in English sentences. A child who does well on the number problems but poorly on the word problems may have an **English barrier rather than a maths difficulty**: check by reading the word problem aloud again, showing it with counters, and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, having it said once in Chinese (mark L). Record the result in the notes.

Likely not yet taught

Chinese kindergartens are asked not to teach primary school content (the policy known as 去小学化), so what a child knows varies a lot; many children also go to extra classes. Ask the parent. A child who has finished the middle year (中班):

Item	May not have been taught
2	Quick recognition of dot patterns as a game, although dice are familiar
3, 4	Reading teen numbers; many kindergartens count to 20 aloud but read numerals only to 10
6, 8	Five and ten frames, and number bonds (数的分成, splitting 5 or 10 into two parts), which are usually taught in the top year (大班)
7	"Double" as a named idea
11	The English word "fewer" ("more" is usually known)
13	The English position words (the ideas are usually known in Chinese)
14	The English words "pattern" and "comes next" (repeating patterns, 找规律, are often met in kindergarten)
15	Sharing equally (平均分) as a named idea

What to look for

- How the child counts: touching each object, counting on from a number, or knowing at a glance. Confidence with numbers beyond 10.
- An English barrier looks like this: the child is lost at first, then answers quickly once you show it with counters or a colleague says it in Chinese. A maths difficulty looks like this: the child cannot do it even when the meaning is clear (for example, cannot count 7 objects reliably).
- Strong children often answer before you finish the question and use counters only to check.

5. Play-based interview and goodbye (6 minutes, page 14)

Use the questions and record in `forms/Interview_Record_Y1_Y2.md`. Sit on the floor or at the low table, open the student booklet at page 14 (Draw) and offer the crayons: the record starts with a drawing ("Can you draw you, doing something you love?"). Play alongside, talk about the drawing and follow the child's lead. Give the speaking band on the interview record, then combine it with the picture talk for the final speaking band in the score summary. The observation boxes in the record cover the whole visit, so fill them in now.

Goodbye. Say: "Thank you, ___! You worked really hard today. I liked ___ (something specific, such as your drawing or your counting). Let's go and find Mum (or Dad)." Do not give any results to the family on the day.

After the visit. Mark everything the same day, complete the score summary below, then the Candidate Summary and Decision.

6. Score summary

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, R, C, access arrangements, behaviour)
Speaking: picture talk and interview		A B C D E	
Listening: follow instructions	/ 10	A B C D E	R:
Early Reading Screen: letter sounds	single letters / 26, letter groups / 18		
Early Reading Screen: phonics words	/ 40		
Early Reading Screen: tricky words	/ 20		
Early Reading Screen: book band, accuracy, questions	book band ____ accuracy ____ % questions ____		
Reading (band from the Early Reading Screen, guide section 6.7)		A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72, reading age _____	indicative	
Writing	/ 16	A B C D E	name: words correct: / 5
Maths	/ 15 (A / 8, B / 7), of which word problems / 3	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Access arrangements (extra time, reader, breaks):

Overall comment (strengths, English profile, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Early Reading Screen: record sheets

One set for each child. Instructions, scripts and marking rules are in `Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Start point used: ☐ Year 1 ☐ Year 2 ☐ Year 3 ☐ Older, new to English. Start time _____ Finish time _____

Sheet 1: Letter sounds

Tick each sound given correctly. Otherwise write what the child said, with N (letter name) or P (pinyin value) where it applies.

Card 1: single letters

s	**m**	**t**	**a**	**o**	**p**
i	**d**	**n**	**e**	**g**	**c**
u	**h**	**b**	**r**	**f**	**k**
l	**w**	**j**	**y**	**v**	**z**
x	**q**				

Right: _____ / 26 Letter names only (N): _____ Pinyin values (P): _____ Not given (start rule) ☐

Card 2: letter groups (only if 15 or more right on Card 1)

sh	**ee**	**ch**	**ai**	**th**	**oo**
ar	**ck**	**oa**	**ng**	**or**	**igh**
qu	**ow**	**ur**	**oi**	**ear**	**air**

Right: _____ / 18 Two separate sounds ("s-h"): _____ Pinyin values (P): _____

Sheet 2: Phonics words

Candidate name _____

R = real word, N = nonsense (creature) word. Score 1 or 0. Write what the child said for every 0, with P, SO or RW where it applies. Section 1 is words 1 to 20 (Cards 4 and 5); Section 2 is words 21 to 40 (Cards 6 and 7). Stop a section after 5 wrong in a row.

No.	Card 4	R/N	1/0	What the child said	No.	Card 6	R/N	1/0	What the child said
1	**map**	R			21	**rain**	R		
2	**dop**	N			22	**jeek**	N		
3	**leg**	R			23	**night**	R		
4	**mub**	N			24	**toap**	N		
5	**sit**	R			25	**moon**	R		
6	**pem**	N			26	**darp**	N		
7	**shop**	R			27	**turn**	R		
8	**chig**	N			28	**sorp**	N		
9	**duck**	R			29	**down**	R		
10	**thep**	N			30	**choil**	N		
	Card 5					**Card 7**			
11	**frog**	R			31	**cake**	R		
12	**blom**	N			32	**jeme**	N		
13	**jump**	R			33	**smile**	R		
14	**nesk**	N			34	**plome**	N		
15	**bring**	R			35	**tube**	R		
16	**trab**	N			36	**flape**	N		
17	**think**	R			37	**garden**	R		
18	**chulp**	N			38	**lompid**	N		
19	**stamp**	R			39	**picnic**	R		
20	**glust**	N			40	**shoomit**	N		

	Real words	Nonsense words	Total
Section 1 (1 to 20)	/ 10	/ 10	/ 20
Section 2 (21 to 40)	/ 10	/ 10	/ 20
Total	/ 20	/ 20	/ 40

P: _____ SO: _____ RW: _____ Notes (patterns, start rule): _____

Sheet 3: Tricky words

Candidate name _____

Score 1 or 0. Write what the child said for every 0. Stop after 5 wrong in a row.

No.	Year 1 list	1/0	What the child said	No.	Year 2 list	1/0	What the child said
1	**the**			11	**door**		
2	**was**			12	**find**		
3	**you**			13	**could**		
4	**said**			14	**water**		
5	**they**			15	**many**		
6	**are**			16	**again**		
7	**come**			17	**half**		
8	**one**			18	**people**		
9	**where**			19	**busy**		
10	**friend**			20	**because**		

Year 1 words: _____ / 10 Year 2 words: _____ / 10 Total: _____ / 20

Passages: quick reference

Passage	Card	Title	Book band	Oxford Level	Words	Independent: errors at most	Pass (90%): errors at most	Pass: questions at least
1	9	Where Is the Cat?	Pink	1+	23	1	2	2 of 3
2	10	At the Market	Red	2	36	1	3	2 of 3
3	11	The Kite	Yellow	3	57	2	5	2 of 4
4	12	A New Friend	Light Blue	4	79	3	7	2 of 4
5	13	The Lucky Dumpling	Green	5	99	4	9	2 of 4
6	14	The Fast Train	Orange	6	126	6	12	2 of 4
7	15	The Rabbit Lantern	Turquoise and Purple	7 to 8	151	7	15	2 of 4
8	16	The Drummer	Gold and White	9 to 10	178	8	17	2 of 4

Record each passage you use on its own sheet (Sheets 4 to 11). For a real levelled book, use Sheet 12.

Sheet 4: Passage 1, Where Is the Cat?

Candidate name _____

Pink band, Oxford Level 1+. 23 words (the title is not counted). Card 9.

Say: "This story is called *Where Is the Cat?*. It is about a cat at home. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	The cat is on the mat.		
2	The cat is on the bed.		
3	The cat is in the box.		
4	The cat is on Dad!		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3
Accuracy %	100	95	91	86
Level	Ind	Ind	Ins	Hard

0 to 1 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **2 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **3 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	Where is the cat at the end of the story?	**On Dad.** Accept "Dad", "on his dad", or pointing to the word "Dad".	
2	Vocabulary	Show me the mat in the picture.	**Points to the mat under the cat.** Pointing is the answer here.	
3	Prediction	Where do you think the cat will go next?	**Any sensible place, in English.** One word is enough: "chair", "table", "on Mum", "garden".	
			Questions right	/ 3

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 3 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Sheet 5: Passage 2, At the Market

Candidate name _____

Red band, Oxford Level 2. 36 words (the title is not counted). Card 10.

Say: "This story is called *At the Market*. It is about a girl called Mei. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	Mei and Gran go to the market.		
2	Gran gets a fish.		
3	Gran gets six eggs.		
4	Gran gets a big melon.		
5	The bag is full.		
6	"I can help," said Mei.		
7	Mei and Gran get on the bus.		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4
Accuracy %	100	97	94	91	88
Level	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 1 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **2 to 3 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **4 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	Who went to the market with Mei?	**Gran.** Accept "her gran", "Grandma", "Granny", "her grandmother".	
2	Inference	How did Mei help Gran?	**She carried the bag (because it was full).** Accept "carry the bag", "hold the bag", "she takes the bag", "she carries the shopping".	
3	Vocabulary	"The bag is full." What does "full" mean?	**There is no more room in it; it has a lot in it.** Accept "lots of things", "a lot in it", "no space", or a clear gesture with "lots".	
			Questions right	/ 3

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 3 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Sheet 6: Passage 3, The Kite

Candidate name _____

Yellow band, Oxford Level 3. 57 words (the title is not counted). Card 11.

Say: "This story is called *The Kite*. It is about a boy called Tom. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	Tom and Dad went to the park.		
2	They had a big green kite.		
3	The wind was strong.		
4	Up, up, up went the kite!		
5	Then it got stuck in a tree.		
6	"Oh no!" said Tom.		
7	Dad got a long stick.		
8	He got the kite down.		
9	"Thank you, Dad!" said Tom.		
10	Soon the kite was up in the sky.		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Accuracy %	100	98	96	94	92	91	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 2 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **3 to 5 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **6 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	Where did the kite get stuck?	**In a tree.** Accept "tree", "up a tree", "on the tree".	
2	Vocabulary	"The wind was strong." What does "strong" mean here?	**The wind was blowing hard; a lot of wind.** Accept "very windy", "big wind", "fast wind", "powerful". Not a "strong muscles" answer.	
3	Inference	How did Tom feel when the kite got stuck?	**Sad, worried or upset.** Accept any fitting feeling: "not happy", "unhappy", "scared", "cross".	
4	Prediction	What do you think Tom and Dad will do next?	**Any sensible idea.** For example: fly the kite again, play, go home.	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Sheet 7: Passage 4, A New Friend

Candidate name _____

Light Blue band, Oxford Level 4. 79 words (the title is not counted). Card 12.

Say: "This story is called *A New Friend*. It is about a boy called Hao at school. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	It was Monday morning.		
2	A new girl came to Hao's class.		
3	Her name was Sofia.		
4	She sat next to Hao.		
5	She did not say a word.		
6	"Do you want to play?" asked Hao.		
7	Sofia looked at the floor.		
8	At playtime, they went outside.		
9	Hao kicked a ball to Sofia.		
10	Sofia kicked it back, hard!		
11	The ball shot past Hao into the net.		
12	"Goal!" shouted Hao. Sofia smiled.		
13	"Can we play again?" she said.		
14	They played until the bell rang.		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Accuracy %	100	98	97	96	94	93	92	91	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 3 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **4 to 7 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **8 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

The questions for this passage are on the next page.

Sheet 7, continued: questions for Passage 4, A New Friend

Candidate name _____

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	What day did the new girl come to Hao's class?	**Monday.** Accept "Monday morning".	
2	Inference	Why do you think Sofia did not say a word at first?	**She was new, shy or nervous.** Accept any sensible reason linked to being new: "she does not know anyone", "she is scared", "she does not speak English".	
3	Vocabulary	"The ball shot past Hao into the net." What does "shot" mean here?	**It went past very fast.** Accept "fast", "quick", "flew", or a fast gesture with "fast".	
4	Personal response	Do you think Hao and Sofia will be friends? Why?	**Yes or no, with a reason from the story.** For example: "yes, they played together", "yes, she smiled". "Yes" alone scores 0; ask once: "Tell me more."	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Notes: patterns in the errors, accent features, pinyin values, words the child did not know, how the child seemed

Sheet 8: Passage 5, The Lucky Dumpling

Candidate name _____

Green band, Oxford Level 5. 99 words (the title is not counted). Card 13.

Say: "This story is called *The Lucky Dumpling*. It is about a girl called Lin at Spring Festival. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	It was the day before Spring Festival. Lin		
2	and Grandma were making dumplings in the		
3	kitchen. Grandma hid a coin inside one of the		
4	dumplings. "The person who finds the coin		
5	will be lucky all year," she said.		
6	That evening, the whole family sat down to		
7	eat. Lin ate one dumpling, then two, then		
8	three. There was no coin. Lin was too full to		
9	eat any more.		
10	Dad found nothing. Mum found nothing.		
11	Then Grandpa bit into a dumpling and		
12	stopped. He smiled and held up the		
13	shiny coin.		
14	"Grandpa is the lucky one!" shouted Lin, and		
15	everyone laughed.		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Accuracy %	100	98	97	96	95	94	93	92	91	90	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 4 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **5 to 9 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **10 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

The questions for this passage are on the next page.

Sheet 8, continued: questions for Passage 5, The Lucky Dumpling

Candidate name _____

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	What did Grandma hide in a dumpling?	**A coin.** Accept "money".	
2	Vocabulary	"He smiled and held up the shiny coin." What does "shiny" mean?	**Bright; it shines.** Accept "bright", "it shines", "sparkly", "glittery".	
3	Inference	Why did Grandpa stop eating?	**He bit the coin; the coin was in his dumpling.** Accept "he found the coin", "the coin was in it", "it was hard".	
4	Personal response	What does your family do at Spring Festival, or at another festival?	**Any fitting answer in English.** One or two words are enough: "eat dumplings", "fireworks", "red packets", "visit Grandma".	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Notes: patterns in the errors, accent features, pinyin values, words the child did not know, how the child seemed

Sheet 9: Passage 6, The Fast Train

Candidate name _____

Orange band, Oxford Level 6. 126 words (the title is not counted). Card 14.

Say: "This story is called *The Fast Train*. It is about a boy called Amir. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	Amir and his mum were going to visit his cousins		
2	in Shanghai. At the station, the fast train was		
3	waiting. It was long and white, with a pointed		
4	nose like a bird.		
5	Amir found his seat next to a big window. At first,		
6	the train moved slowly. Then it went faster and		
7	faster. Green fields, rivers and tall buildings		
8	rushed past.		
9	"This train is even faster than our car!"		
10	said Amir.		
11	After a while, a lady pushed a trolley along the		
12	carriage. Mum bought two bowls of noodles and a		
13	bottle of water. Amir ate his noodles and looked		
14	out of the window. Soon his eyes began to close.		
15	When he woke up, the train had stopped. "Wake		
16	up, sleepy head," said Mum. "We are here!"		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Accuracy %	100	99	98	97	96	96	95	94	93	92	92	91	90	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 6 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **7 to 12 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **13 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

The questions for this passage are on the next page.

Sheet 9, continued: questions for Passage 6, The Fast Train

Candidate name _____

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	Where were Amir and his mum going?	**To Shanghai, to visit his cousins.** Accept either part: "Shanghai" or "to see his cousins".	
2	Vocabulary	"Green fields, rivers and tall buildings rushed past." What does "rushed past" mean?	**They went past very quickly.** Accept "went fast", "moved fast", "zoomed", or a fast gesture with "fast".	
3	Inference	Why did Mum call Amir "sleepy head"?	**He fell asleep on the train.** Accept "he was sleeping", "he was tired", "his eyes closed".	
4	Prediction	What do you think Amir will do in Shanghai?	**Any sensible idea.** For example: play with his cousins, eat, visit places.	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Notes: patterns in the errors, accent features, pinyin values, words the child did not know, how the child seemed

Sheet 10: Passage 7, The Rabbit Lantern

Candidate name _____

Turquoise and Purple band, Oxford Level 7 to 8. 151 words (the title is not counted). Card 15.

Say: "This story is called *The Rabbit Lantern*. It is about a boy called Chen Yu at the Mid-Autumn Festival. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	Every year, Chen Yu's class made paper lanterns for		
2	the Mid-Autumn Festival. This year, Miss Wang		
3	showed them how to make a rabbit.		
4	Chen Yu cut out two long ears and glued them on		
5	carefully. But when he held up his lantern, one ear		
6	flopped down. The rabbit's face was crooked, too. Next		
7	to him, Aisha had made a perfect rabbit with neat		
8	pink eyes.		
9	"Mine looks silly," Chen Yu said quietly.		
10	That evening, his family walked to the park by the lake.		
11	The full moon was round and bright, and hundreds of		
12	lanterns glowed in the dark. Grandpa put a small light		
13	inside the rabbit, and it began to shine.		
14	A little girl pulled her mother's sleeve. "Look at that		
15	rabbit!" she said. "It is waving its ear at me!"		
16	Chen Yu looked at his lantern again. Then he smiled,		
17	lifted it high and made the floppy ear wave hello.		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
Accuracy %	100	99	98	98	97	96	96	95	94	94	93	92	92	91	90	90	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 7 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **8 to 15 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **16 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

The questions for this passage are on the next page.

Sheet 10, continued: questions for Passage 7, The Rabbit Lantern

Candidate name _____

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	Where did Chen Yu's family go that evening?	**To the park by the lake.** Accept "the park" or "the lake".	
2	Vocabulary	"The rabbit's face was crooked." What does "crooked" mean?	**Not straight; to one side.** Accept "not straight", "wonky", "on one side", or a tilting gesture with "not right".	
3	Inference	How did Chen Yu feel about his lantern at school? Why?	**Sad, disappointed or embarrassed, because it was not perfect (the ear flopped, the face was crooked, Aisha's was better).** Score 1 for a fitting feeling. Note whether the child gives a reason.	
4	Inference	Why did Chen Yu smile at the end?	**The little girl liked his rabbit; the floppy ear looked as if it was waving.** Accept any answer linked to the girl or the waving ear, or "he was happy (proud) now", "his lantern looked good".	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Notes: patterns in the errors, accent features, pinyin values, words the child did not know, how the child seemed

Sheet 11: Passage 8, The Drummer

Candidate name _____

Gold and White band, Oxford Level 9 to 10. 178 words (the title is not counted). Card 16.

Say: "This story is called *The Drummer*. It is about a boy called Zhang Wei and a dragon boat race. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Line	Text: write your marks above the words	E	SC
1	Zhang Wei had never felt so nervous. It was the Dragon		
2	Boat Festival, and his school was racing three other boats		
3	on the lake. Twelve children sat in two long rows, holding		
4	their paddles. At the front sat the drummer, and this year		
5	the drummer was Zhang Wei.		
6	"Remember," said Coach Liu, "the paddlers listen to your		
7	drum. Keep a steady beat, and they will paddle together."		
8	The whistle blew, and the boats shot forward. Zhang Wei		
9	was so excited that he beat the drum far too fast. Behind		
10	him, the paddles splashed in a muddle, and the boat began		
11	to wobble. Another boat slid past them.		
12	Zhang Wei took a deep breath. He thought of the clock in		
13	his classroom, ticking slowly and evenly. Boom, boom,		
14	boom. One by one, the paddlers found the beat, and the		
15	boat flew across the water like an arrow.		
16	They did not win, but they came a close second.		
17	Afterwards, Coach Liu shook Zhang Wei's hand. "A good		
18	drummer does not just make a noise," she said. "A good		
19	drummer listens."		
	Totals		

Errors	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
Accuracy %	100	99	98	98	97	97	96	96	95	94	94	93	93	92	92	91	91	90	89
Level	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ind	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Ins	Hard

0 to 8 errors: 95% or more, independent (Ind). **9 to 17 errors:** 90 to 94%, instructional (Ins). **18 or more:** below 90%, too hard. Percentages are rounded down.

Errors: _____ Self-corrections: _____ Accuracy: _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

The questions for this passage are on the next page.

Sheet 11, continued: questions for Passage 8, The Drummer

Candidate name _____

Then say: "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story."

Q	Type	Ask	Expected answer, and what else to accept	1 or 0
1	Literal	What happened at the end of the race?	**They came second (a close second).** Accept "second", "they nearly won", "another boat won". "They lost" alone: ask once "Tell me more."	
2	Vocabulary	"The paddles splashed in a muddle." What does "in a muddle" mean?	**Mixed up; not together.** Accept "messy", "mixed up", "not at the same time", "everyone different", "all wrong".	
3	Inference	Why did Zhang Wei think of the clock in his classroom?	**To help him slow down and keep a slow, even beat.** Accept "to go slower", "to keep the beat", "so they paddle together", "tick, tick, slowly".	
4	Inference	Coach Liu said, "A good drummer listens." What did she mean?	**A drummer must pay attention to the team and the beat, not just bang the drum.** Accept any answer about listening to or watching the paddlers or the beat, or not just making a loud noise.	
			Questions right	/ 4

Pass (90% or more **and** at least 2 of 4 questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No. Next: a pass, go up one passage; not a pass, stop (or go down one if this was the first passage).

Notes: patterns in the errors, accent features, pinyin values, words the child did not know, how the child seemed

Sheet 12: Running record for a levelled book

Candidate name _____

Book title _____

Band _____ Oxford Level _____ Pages read _____ **Words read (N)** _____

Say: "This story is called _____. It is about _____. Read it to me, please. If you do not know a word, try it."

Use one tick for each word read correctly, line by line, and the marks in 4.6 for everything else.

Page	Ticks and marks	E	SC
	Totals		

Accuracy = (N minus errors) ÷ N × 100 = _____ %. A quick check: 95% allows 1 error in every 20 words; 90% allows 1 error in every 10 words (100 words: 5 and 10 errors; 150 words: 7 and 15 errors).

Self-corrections _____ SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4

Q	Type	Question (write before you start)	Expected answer	1 or 0
1	Literal			
2	Inference			
3	Vocabulary			
4	Prediction or personal			

Pass (90% or more **and** at least half the questions): ☐ Yes ☐ No

Sheet 13: Summary (copy onto the Candidate Summary form)

Candidate name _____

Early Reading Screen	Result
Date, assessor, time	Date _____ Assessor _____ Start _____ Finish _____ (_____ minutes)
Start point	☐ Year 1 ☐ Year 2 ☐ Year 3 ☐ Older, new to English. Parts skipped by a start rule: _____
Letter sounds	Single letters _____ / 26 Letter groups _____ / 18 N (names only) _____ P (pinyin) _____
Phonics words	Section 1 _____ / 20 (real _____ / 10, nonsense _____ / 10) Section 2 _____ / 20 (real _____ / 10, nonsense _____ / 10) Total _____ / 40 P _____ SO _____ RW _____
Tricky words	Year 1 words _____ / 10 Year 2 words _____ / 10
Book band level	Passage _____ (or book: _____) Band _____ Oxford Level _____ ☐ not yet Pink
At that level	Accuracy _____ % SC rate 1 : _____ Fluency _____ / 4 Questions _____ / _____
Decodes at (if higher)	Highest passage read at 90% or more: _____ (questions _____ / _____)
Reading band	**A B C D E** (circle; guide, 6.7)
Pattern	☐ decoding secure ☐ decoding ahead of understanding ☐ understanding ahead of decoding ☐ pinyin values ☐ letter names only ☐ vocabulary gaps
Access and behaviour	Breaks, extra time, stopped early, how the child seemed: _____
Next steps for teaching	_____

One line for the Candidate Summary: for example, for a Year 3 entrant: "ERS: letters 24/26, phonics 31/40 (S1 18, S2 13), tricky 14/20; book band Light Blue (P4, 93%, 3/4 questions, fluency 2); pinyin vowels; reading band C."

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Child interview and suitability record: Years 1 and 2

Child's name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 6 minutes, 1:1, play-based. Most of what you need about a 5 or 6 year old comes from watching them during the whole visit, not from questions. This short chat, at the end of the visit, is **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, family, friends, **what they want to be**), and to judge their readiness for the international programme. Use the observation boxes in Section 4 for the whole visit.

How to do it. Sit on the floor or at a low table beside the child. Offer paper and crayons: "Can you draw you, doing something you love?" Talk about the drawing. Ask the main question first; if the child does not answer, use the **easier** prompt (a choice, a yes or no, or "show me"). Wait. Praise effort. Never press a child who is upset; stop and let them go back to their parent.

Safeguarding. A young child is never alone with one adult behind a closed door. If a child says something that worries you, write down their words and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions

Topic	Main question	Easier	Notes
Me	What is your name? How old are you?	Show me with your fingers.	
	Tell me about your picture.	Is this you? What are you doing?	
Family	Who lives at your home?	Do you have a brother? A sister? A pet?	
Likes	What do you like to play?	Do you like to run? Draw? Play with blocks?	
	What is your favourite food? Favourite animal?	Do you like noodles? Do you like cats?	
School	Tell me about your school (or kindergarten).	Do you like it? What do you do there?	
	Who are your friends?	Do you play with friends?	
Feelings	What makes you happy?	Are you happy today? (point to a happy or sad face)	
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	A teacher? A doctor? A footballer?	
Here	Would you like to come to this school? What would you like to do here?	Do you want to play here? Learn English here?	

2. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best, for a child of this age.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or one or two words. Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. May copy a word you say.
B Early acquisition	Single words and short phrases ("cat", "my mummy", "I like red"). Understands simple questions with gesture or pictures.
C Developing competence	Short sentences about familiar things ("I play with my friend"), with errors. Understands most simple questions.
D Competent	Talks in sentences, tells you about the picture or a simple event, joins ideas with "and" or "because".
E Fluent	Talks as a fluent English-speaking child of 5 or 6 would.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

3. Observations during the whole visit

Tick what you saw, and add a note.

What to look for	Seen	Notes
Separates from the parent without great distress, or settles within a few minutes	☐	
Joins in the activities and stays with each one for a few minutes	☐	
Follows a simple instruction (with gesture if needed)	☐	
Holds a pencil or crayon with control; draws a person with several parts	☐	
Takes turns, shares, waits	☐	
Shows curiosity: looks, touches, asks, explores	☐	
Copies new English words, or tries to	☐	
Recovers when something is hard or when they do not understand	☐	
Uses the toilet, coat and shoes independently (ask the parent)	☐	

4. Readiness

Rate each strand. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning	Enjoys the activities, has a go, pleased with success	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Interested, explores, asks questions	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Settles with new adults, manages separation, plays alongside or with others	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence	Manages simple tasks and self-care for age	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Kindness and conduct	Gentle, polite, shares	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for learning in English	Happy in an English-speaking setting, tries words, is not distressed by not understanding	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Speech and language (for example very little speech in Chinese as well as English, unclear speech for age)	☐	
Attention, hearing, vision, movement or fine motor skills	☐	
Wellbeing (for example very anxious, very tired)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	

Speech in Chinese. Ask the parent how the child speaks in Chinese (Parent Conversation Record, Section 4). A child with little English but age-appropriate Chinese is a typical English learner. A child who also has very little speech in Chinese for their age may need a speech and language check: raise it with the parent gently, as a question rather than a conclusion.

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

First impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a familiar comfort object, a gradual start).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Paper version sat: _____ (for example v3.1; it is on the front page and in the footer of every paper)

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 6: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___). Years 7 to 10: reading paper ___ / 16 (A ___ B ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10: fluency)	Word problems (Years 7 to 10: word questions)	Applied (Years 7 to 10)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The Years 7 to 10 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In Years 7 to 10, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			